

Smyrna
Vinings

The

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Volume 22, No. 4

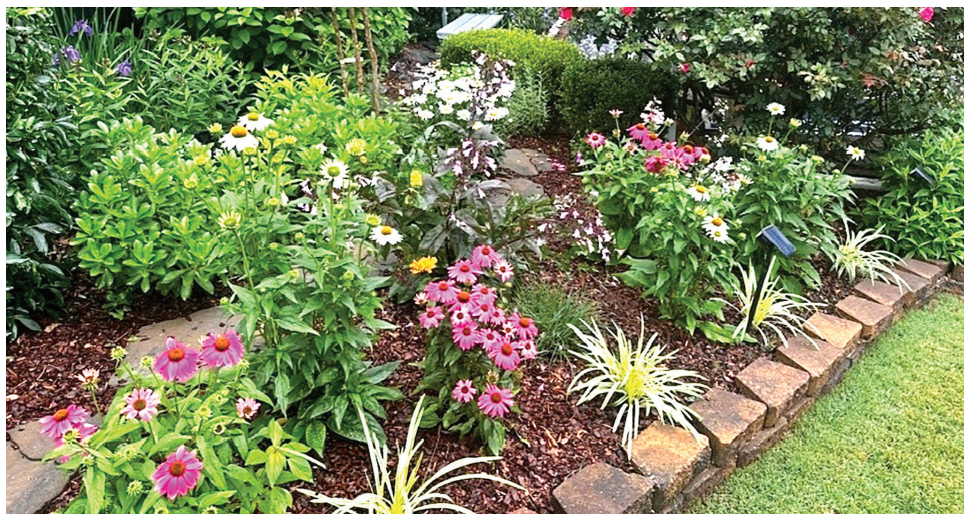
A Community Newspaper for Smyrna, Vinings and South Cobb

APRIL 2026

SMYRNA GARDEN TOUR

Saturday, May 2, 2026

10am to 4pm



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SMYRNA CELEBRATES SPRING WITH ITS ANNUAL GARDEN TOUR

Keep Smyrna Beautiful's Garden Tour returns on Saturday, May 2, offering self-guided exploration of five of Smyrna's most stunning gardens. This year's theme "Homegrown Habitats," celebrates gardens that support pollinators while making our city a more beautiful place to live.

"Expect to see gardens that support pollinators and be inspired to create the same in your yard," says Garden Tour Committee Chair Dawn McLoughlin. "The five featured gardens range from a certified native garden, two well-established pollinator gardens, a bright and bountiful ornamental, and a well-designed pollinator garden growing within an HOA."

Keep Smyrna Beautiful hopes that the tour will inspire Smyrna residents to beautify their own outdoor spaces while supporting pollinators, which are critical for a healthy ecosystem, biodiversity, and food production, but face challenges including habitat loss and competition from non-native species.

Proceeds from the Smyrna Garden Tour support litter cleanups, environmental education, community events, and more. As Keep Smyrna Beautiful's largest annual fundraiser,

this event plays a vital role in sustaining local beautification efforts.

During the tour, ticket holders are invited to stop by the Tea Room at the Reed House, 3080 Atlanta Road SE, to enjoy complimentary refreshments.

While there, they can enjoy music from local musicians including Todd DeFeo (@ToddDeFeo), Jocelyn Steward (@MusicStudioLC), Jitterbug Performing Arts students (@JitterbugPerformingArts), Bettina & Briella (@bloomwithBettina), Reid Stevens and Friends (@33andOneThirdRecords), and students of Holly Tate, a Cup of Rainbows Music & Art (@aCupOfRainbows). Artists will be creating art at select gardens on the tour.

Guests at the Reed House can also browse a public plant sale, featuring a variety of perennials and annuals for sale, including a large selection of native plants.

Tickets are available online at keepsmyrnabeautiful.com/garden-tour and in-person at Smyrna Recycling Center, Vickery Hardware, and Floral Creations. Advance Tickets: \$20; Day-of Tickets: \$25.

CELEBRATE SPRING AT SMYRNA'S JONQUIL FESTIVAL

As the jonquils bloom and the weather turns warm, the city of Smyrna is ready to celebrate spring. The city's Jonquil Festival has something for every member of the family with more than 175 Arts & Crafts booths, 20 food booths, an entertainment stage, multiple beer gardens, and a variety of children's activities.

This year's Jonquil Festival will be held in and around Smyrna's City Hall and the Market Village for two days: Saturday April 25 and Sunday April 26. On Saturday; April 26, the events run from 10 a.m. to 6 p.m. On Sunday the event runs from noon to 5 p.m.



For those who enjoy shopping, there is a vast array of items including jewelry, hand-crafted wooden items, and much more. There are food booths for different tastes. Among the returning entertainments are:

Live Music: Scott Thompson and multiple musicians will take the stage

continued on page 4

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MAY 2, 2026

The 5th Annual Taste of Mableton, will be May 2, 2026 at the Mable House Complex located at 5239 Floyd Road in Mableton.

The activities will begin at 9 a.m. last until 4 p.m.

[mableton.org/
taste-of-mableton](https://mableton.org/taste-of-mableton)

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Comments By Cathy

GARDENS ADD BEAUTY TO OUR LIVES

By Cathy Shattles Lipsett
Editor/Publisher



When I moved from my house of 35 years, I knew I would miss my flowers and my trees. They had brightened my life from season to season. But I was fortunate that my downsizing move brought new beauty into my life.

The condo I moved into is on a corner, with a large lot filled with flowers and trees. Someone who had lived there years in the past had planted camellia bushes, azaleas, daffodils, hyacinths, forsythia, and dogwoods. This spring they all managed to bloom at one time, bringing me joy every time I look outside.

We are fortunate living here in Georgia with our array of greenery and blossoms throughout the year.

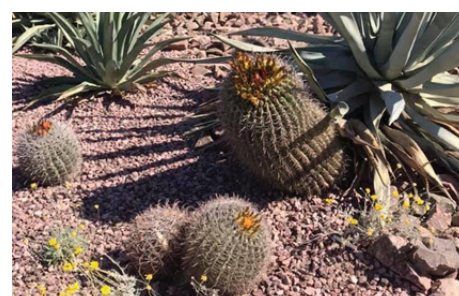
I have family in Arizona and I love visiting there. The desert landscaping, so different from here in Georgia, can be lovely. One of my favorite Arizona places to visit is the Desert Botanical Gardens. But after a long visit, I am ready to see the greenery of home.

On May 2 of this year, Smyrna gardens are on display for visitors to enjoy. Sponsored by Keep Smyrna Beautiful, the annual garden tour is a must see for those who enjoy a beautiful garden or for those who want to gather ideas for their own gardens.

Whether it's in a yard filled with flowers or just a blooming plant on a window sill, plants can bring joy to our lives. I wish all of my readers a life filled with sunshine and flowers.



Azaleas and camellia bushes
in my condo yard



Cacti at the Arizona Botanical Garden



Forsythia planted by Allan at our home several years before his death

The next issue of
The Bright Side™ will be
published the week of May 5.

Deadline: April 25

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Cathy S. Lipsett, Editor & Publisher
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EAGLE SYNDROME

Eagle syndrome is a condition where—*now stay with me here*—the styloid process of the temporal bone becomes elongated and the stylohyoid ligament becomes calcified. The styloid process is a sharp, spike-like bone that points downward from the underside of the skull, just behind each ear. The stylohyoid ligaments normally form a chin-strap-like suspensory connection from the points of the styloid to each side of the horseshoe-shaped hyoid bone, which is located in the throat, just above the Adam’s apple, thus the term, “stylohyoid”.

Pain and frustration seem to be the lot for those with Eagle’s Syndrome. They run the gamut of doctors for help and scarcely get relief for their wide array of symptoms: sharp, “electric-shock” pain in the tonsils, tongue and back of the throat caused when speaking or eating or turning one’s head, the pain often spreading to the temple, eye, ear or back of head; and the sense of “a foreign body” in the throat or tongue. Other symptoms include dry cough, vertigo, even loss of consciousness.

In speaking directly to a man who had Eagle syndrome, he reported to me the following symptoms: blurry and dim vision, changes in head position causing changes in heart rate and blood pressure, altered taste (water tasting like maple syrup), facial numbness and spasticity, the ears had a popping, bubbling and full feeling with decreased hearing sensitivity, jaw popping, crawling skin, blocked nasal passages, chronic swollen glands, purulent throat infections, difficulty swallowing, insomnia, constant pain and, not surprisingly, a short temper.

When this stylohyoid complex is abnormally large and rigid, it exerts pressure on three cranial nerves in the



Dr. Derek Conte
Columnist

area (Glossopharyngeal, Facial and Trigeminal) potentially resulting in all of the symptoms mentioned. Misdiagnosis or mistreatment is common. Diagnosis is difficult to do by X-ray, but the prominence of the bones can be felt under the ear, behind and under the angle of the jaw.

Trauma is thought to be the cause, as in the way a broken foot or hand bone may heal in a tangle with adjacent bones due to overexuberant healing causing loss of range of motion. But there may be another connection I see, based on other disorders also found in those with Eagle’s syndrome: 64% had bone diseases where trauma, inflammation or bone growth miscues play a big role, 27% had atherosclerosis, >11% had cervical/facial trauma, and many others had autoimmune disorders (rheumatism) and infections (tuberculosis). All are inflammatory. Eagle syndrome is present in about 1 in 125 to 250 people (mostly women) the odds going up as we reach retirement age. Surgical removal of the bones is superior to anesthetics or steroids as treatments, which offer only temporary relief.

The man I spoke to had been transformed by the correction of his problem and looked years younger, finally happy and hopeful, and grateful for the years of life ahead: a true blessing.

Also See: Clinic, Diagnostics and Treatment Peculiarities of Eagle’s Syndrome, By Gervicas, Kubilius and Sabalys; and see: An Unusually Lengthy Styloid Process, By Prabhu, Nayak, Vadgaonkar, Krishnamurthy and Madhan.

Dr. Derek Conte is co-founder of Chiropractic Specialists on Concord Road in Smyrna. For questions call, 404-784-6008. For more articles, photos or info, go to drderekconte.com.

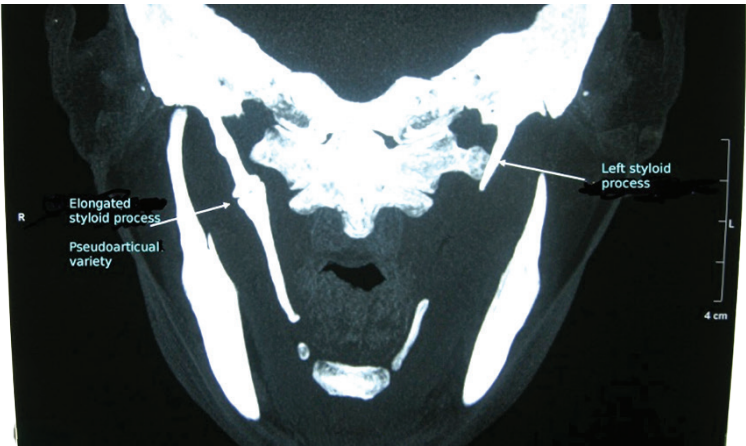


Image from drtbalu.blogspot.com/2010/05/eagles-syndrome.html

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throughout the day across two stages near the Spring Jonquil Food Court. Grab a drink from one of two beer gardens, bring a blanket, sing along, and relax in a beautiful setting with family and friends..

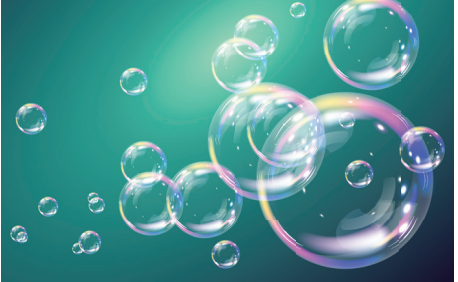


The Georgia Grown Member Market: Highlighting goods and products from all over the state of Georgia.



The Amazing Bubble Factory is a high-energy, visually stunning show that turns ordinary bubbles into extraordinary entertainment. Producing millions of bubbles throughout each performance, this interactive act features jaw-dropping bubble tricks ranging from tiny, pea-

sized creations to enormous bubbles large enough to surround a minivan. Saturday and Sunday: 12, 2, & 4 PM.



Interactive Kids Zone: Bring the kids, as they are sure to be entertained with a wide variety of inflatable slides, bounces, and much more sponsored by St. Benedict's Episcopal School.



Admission to the Jonquil Festival is FREE and 30,000 people are expected to attend. For more information call 770-423-1330 or e-mail missy@jrmmanagement.com or visit smyrnacity.com.

TASTE OF MABLETON COMING MAY 2

The 2026 Taste of Mableton takes place at the Mable House Complex and features the flavors, people, artisans, and culture that makes the City of Mableton unique. The event features a parade, a kids zone, live music, performances, and more.



Come out on Saturday, May 2 from 10 a.m. to 4 p.m. and try all things Mableton – additional events include Tours and Displays, Pillars of Mableton, Health & Wellness Village, Arts & Crafts Exhibits, Public Safety Zone, Service Row, DJ and Dancing, Education Pavilion, Faith Village, Civic Circle, All Day Concert at the Amphitheatre, Family Fun Zone, The Marketplace, and Foodies Court. The festival starts at 9 a.m. with a parade that starts at Floyd Middle School and ends at the Mable House Complex. Following the parade is the Battle of the Bands, featuring the Pebblebrook High School Mighty Marching Machine, the South Cobb High School Blue Eagle Marching Band, and The Osborne Red Sea of Sound.

Admission is free. The Taste of Mableton is set for the Mable House Complex, 5239 Floyd Road, Mableton. Free onsite will be available at the Mable House Complex, with additional free overflow parking available at the South Cobb Regional Library, 805 Clay Rd, Mableton. For more information, please email tasteofmableton@mableton.org or call (404) 997-2893.



**Saturday, April 25
10:00am - 6:00pm**

**Sunday, April 26
Noon - 5:00pm**



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Located in the Market Village & Village Green
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For more information call 770-423-1330 or www.smyrnaga.gov

PRIMARY VOTING BEGINS IN APRIL

Georgians will be back to the voting booths on May 19 for the 2026 primary for a variety of state-wide and local elections. This election is used by political parties to choose their nominees for the November General Election. It also includes nonpartisan offices, including many judges, where the actual winner is decided on that day.

Early voting begins on Monday, April 27 and continues to Friday, May 15. Georgia’s 2026 Primary is May 19, and the General Election is November 3. The ballots will include, among other offices, state representatives and senators, Governor, Lt. Governor, State Attorney General, Public Service Commission, US Congress, and one US Georgia Senate seat.

To find the candidates in the state-wide primary, visit www.thecurrentga.org. Winners of partisan races will meet in the Nov. 3 General Election. You may register to vote by April 20. Check your Georgia voting status at www.sos.ga.gov/how-to-guide/how-guide-registering-vote.



JONQUIL CITY JOG SET FOR MAY 2

Lace up your sneakers and join us for the Jonquil City Jog on Saturday, May 2, beginning at 8 a.m. This jog features a 5K at 8 a.m., a 1-mile at approximately 9 a.m. with the Tot Trot to follow.



The race will begin at Smyrna City Hall in downtown Smyrna. As one of the best community races in the Metro Atlanta area, the Jonquil City Jog consistently draws a great crowd for this flat, fast and family-friendly course. Visit www.smyrnaga.gov to register. If you need to wait until the day of the race, registration will open at 7:00 a.m. that morning.

Proceeds will benefit the Campbell High School Educational Foundation, Inc. and Support Smyrna. The Campbell High School Educational Foundation is a non-profit organization that provides financial and community support to Campbell High School.

Throughout the pandemic, Support Smyrna was able to help feed hundreds of Smyrna families in need and continues to support the Smyrna community. They are expanding their mission within the Smyrna community to help veterans, seniors, students, and others in need.

RIBBON CUTTING HELD FOR MENTAL HEALTH MURAL

Attendees had a great opportunity to celebrate the finished mental health mural created by Paint Love and displayed at the Cobb Collaborative office for the ribbon cutting. Local establishments such as Glenn’s Cafe and the First Christian Church of Mableton (FCCM) allowed the sections of the mural to be placed at their locations where people could show up to paint. The ribbon cutting featured words of inspiration from Commissioner Sheffield, City of Mableton Councilman TJ Ferguson, Paint Love, Cobb Collaborative, FCCM’s Barry Smith and others. The mural will be displayed at Switzer Library and eventually moved to Discovery Park.





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Smyrna Garden Tour

Saturday, May 2, 2026 10am-4pm

- Self-guided tour of five Smyrna gardens
- Tea room & plant sale at the Reed House
- Purchase tickets with QR code or in-person at the Smyrna Recycling Center, Vickery Hardware, or Floral Creations
- \$20 in advance / \$25 day of

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Community Calendar

Read full Calendar at www.brightsidecobb.com

APRIL

21: COBB SENIOR EXPO.

The Cobb County Senior Services Annual Expo will take place Tuesday, April 21 from 10 a.m. until 2 p.m. at Jim Miller Park. There will be more vendors than ever before. We've packed the house with 120+ local businesses, nonprofits, and community partners. *FREE Admission and FREE Parking.*

25: NEWCOMERS CLUB.

The Newcomers Club of Cobb County welcomes area women to join them at their monthly meeting. The next meeting will be held on Tuesday, April 21, at 10 a.m. at John Knox Presbyterian Church, 505 Powers Ferry Road, Marietta. Make new friends while learning from a speaker on topics interesting to women. New to the area or newly looking for fun activities and new friends? Come join us! For more information, visit newcomersofcobbcounty.com.

25 & 26: SMYRNA JONQUIL FESTIVAL.

The Spring Jonquil Festival is located on the beautiful Village Green in downtown Smyrna. There will be 150 arts and crafts booths, food booths, a beer garden, and plenty of children's activities. The show will also feature a local entertainment stage. The show will draw crowds of around 25,000 people.



MAY

2: SMYRNA GARDEN TOUR.

The Smyrna Garden Tour is back on May 2, connecting ticket holders to five of Smyrna's most beautiful private gardens. This self-guided tour helps raise money to support the work of Keep Smyrna Beautiful, including litter cleanups, habitat rehabilitation, pollinator gardens, environmental education, and more! Sponsorships are available. Learn more at keepsmyrnabeautiful.com/garden-tour.

2: TASTE OF MABLETON.

The free festival starts at 9 a.m. with a 30-minute parade followed by a Battle of the Bands. Food Court with 20 plus vendors, Market Place with artisan and craft vendors, a kids fun zone, and much more. 9 a.m.-4 p.m.; Mable House Complex, 5239 Floyd Road, Mableton.

ORGANIZATIONS WEEKLY

BOY SCOUT TROOP 1.

Join Troop 1 Smyrna, where adventure meets leadership. Our vibrant Scouts BSA troop is Scout-led, thriving on teamwork, camaraderie, and the values of the Scout Oath and Law. We camp monthly, explore exciting outdoor adventures, and focus on building skills that last a lifetime. Meetings are held on Sundays from 4:30-6 p.m., providing a welcoming space to grow, lead, and have fun—except on holiday weekends or during our thrilling camping trips. Come be part of the adventure and discover what makes Troop 1 a community like no other. troop1smyrna.com | troop1smyrna@gmail.com 770-742-8858.

SCOUTING AMERICA TROOP 220 (FOR BOYS) AND 1872 (FOR GIRLS).

Come to Life Church to enjoy Scouting America's (formally BSA) programs where we have both Boy and Girl Units. Combined with Pack 22 we provide Scouting for the whole family! Troops 1872 and 220 have monthly campouts/adventures and hold regular meetings located at Life Church Smyrna Assembly of God, 4100 King Springs Road (next to Griffin Middle School).

Meetings times:

Troop 1872: Sundays | 2-3:30 p.m.
Troop 220: Tuesdays | 6:30-8 p.m.

We are focused on leadership, adventure, and established Scouting Values that have been around for 100+ years. For more information, visit troopwebhost.org/Troop220smyrna.

THE JONQUIL CITY KIWANIS CLUB. Meets on Tuesdays from 10-11 a.m. at the Wolfe Center at 884 Church St. Smyrna. All are welcome. Please come early for fellowship and refreshments.

SMYRNA BNI. Smyrna Business Exchange BNI, the largest and most successful BNI Chapter in all North Georgia (including the Atlanta Metro area) meets Thursday mornings from 7-8:30 a.m. (networking, coffee and breakfast starting at 6:45 a.m.) The group meets at Smyrna First Baptist Church, 1275 Church St SE, Smyrna. Enter behind the church in the "Welcome Center." You can reach them online at bniatl.com.

SMYRNA OPTIMIST. Meets every Friday, 7-8 a.m. at the American Legion Post 160, located at 160 Legion Drive.

EXTRA BRIGHT SIDES

EXTRA COPIES: Looking for an extra copy of The Bright Side?

Copies are available each month in the Smyrna Library, the Smyrna Community Center, Vickery Hardware, Kroger South Cobb Drive, and Jonquil Publix Atlanta Road, Smyrna; Mableton Pharmacy, Floyd Road Kroger; Mableton Art Center, and in Austell: The Treadmill. Also available at advertiser locations. On our website brightsidecobb.com sign up for our electronic weekly that has more local news and calendar items every Friday.

TOASTMASTERS' MEETINGS.

T-Toasters of Vinings meets every Wednesday night starting at 6 p.m. Meetings are held at 2727 Paces Ferry Rd, Building 2 in the 3rd floor conference room. Look for our banner and come join the fun! For more information, visit t-toasters.com or email amberenson@gmail.com.

VININGS CUMBERLAND ROTARY CLUB. In-person weekly meetings and on zoom; Every Wednesday at noon. The meetings are held at Copeland's of New Orleans, 3101 Cobb Parkway, Vinings. For more information, visit viningsrotary.org or contact Shawn Bendig at shawnbendig@att.net or 404-374-6027.

SMYRNA ROTARY CLUB. Meets Tuesdays at 12:15 p.m. Join for a warm welcome, great fellowship, wonderful speakers, and community, national and international service projects. For more information, email Smyrna Rotary Club at f2@nfiweb.com.

GROUPS

RELATIONSHIPS IN RECOVERY. The oldest meeting on campus, meets every Saturday night at 7:30 p.m. in the Pro North building at Ridgeview Institute, 3995 S. Cobb Drive, Smyrna. A 12-step format meeting helping people in relationships with the many aspects of recovery.

TO LIST AN EVENT. E-mail your organization's calendar news to news@brightsidecobb.com. Please send in a Word format as short as possible and no flyers. Calendar items also go into the electronic weekly every Friday. To subscribe to the eWeekly go to brightsidecobb.com and click on the red button.

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KEEP SMYRNA BEAUTIFUL RECEIVED GOVERNOR'S CIRCLE AWARD

Keep Smyrna Beautiful recently received a 2025 Governor's Circle Award for its outstanding achievements in community beautification and environmental sustainability. The Keep Georgia Beautiful Foundation (KGBF) presented the award in recognition of exemplary performance in litter reduction, waste minimization, and community greening.

To qualify for the Governor's Circle Award, affiliates must be certified and in good standing with Keep America Beautiful (KAB), the national nonprofit that oversees state and local programming. Additionally, the affiliate must be an active member of the KGBF network. Certified KAB affiliates are required to effect meaningful, positive, and lasting change by directly addressing community needs in the areas of litter prevention, recycling, waste reduction, and beautification.

"Across Georgia, we're focused on creating clean, green, and beautiful communities for everyone to enjoy," said Natalie Johnston-Russell, executive director of the Keep Georgia Beautiful Foundation. "This year's award recipients exemplify what's possible when passion meets action, and we're proud to recognize their outstanding contributions."

In 2025, Keep Smyrna Beautiful made significant strides in environmental stewardship across the



community. The organization engaged volunteers who donated more than 7,000 hours of their time, reached more than 2,600 people through environmental education initiatives, and removed more than 21,000 pounds of litter from local roadways. A standout milestone was the establishment of the city's first Pollinator Pocket garden—the beginning of an ambitious effort to install one in each ward of Smyrna over the coming years, creating vital habitat for bees, butterflies, and other essential pollinators.

"We are so proud of how hard our community works to protect the environment and keep Smyrna clean, green, and beautiful," said Julie Barwig, Executive Director of Keep Smyrna Beautiful and Director of Environmental Services for the City of Smyrna. "We couldn't do it without our dedicated volunteers, generous sponsors, and committed city leaders who share our vision for a healthier, more beautiful Smyrna."

To learn more about our work in the community, visit www.keepersmyrnabeautiful.com.

Brown Bag

Brown Bag
CONCERT SERIES

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@ 12 noon

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SENIOR CITIZENS NEWS

FOR SMYRNA/VININGS/MABLETON/AUSTELL

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Visit www.CobbSeniors.org for daily activities.
Registration available online and in-person.

Seniors are you looking for activities or need a place to meet new friends? Why not visit the Freeman Poole Senior Center located at 4025 South Hurt Road, Smyrna? Join a lunch and learn class, enjoy a cooking demonstration, play bingo or join a book reading club. Whatever your interest may be, there’s plenty to do at Freeman Poole.

APRIL

STUDENT SPOTLIGHT: PIANO CLASSICS AND FAVORITES

Friday April 10 | 12:30–1:30 p.m.
Free; *Registration required.*

Join us for a special afternoon of live piano music featuring a talented pianist from Osborne High School. Guests will enjoy a delightful selection of familiar favorites and soothing melodies, all while supporting a gifted young musician from our community.

ALL ABOUT POLLINATORS

Thursday, April 16 | 11:30 a.m.–12:30 p.m.
Free; *Registration required.*
Join Keep Cobb Beautiful for an engaging and educational presentation on the vital role pollinators play in our environment and everyday lives. From bees and butterflies to birds and bats, pollinators are responsible for supporting healthy ecosystems and contributing to one out of every three bites of food we eat. Whether you’re a gardener or community member who cares about keeping Cobb County beautiful and thriving, this session will provide practical tools and inspiration to help protect these essential species.

THE FREEMAN POOLE PAGE TURNERS

Thursday, April 16 | 10:30–11:30 a.m.
Free; *Registration required.*

Freeman Poole’s Page Turners book club offers a welcoming space to engage in meaningful conversations, share insights, and discover new authors and genres. The book of the month is *Where the Rivers Merge* by Mary Alice Monroe.



STABLE HORSE VISIT TO COBB COUNTY

Friday April 17 | 10 a.m.–Noon
Free; *Registration required.*

Did you know that Cobb County operates a mounted patrol unit supported by a seven-horse stable? Join us for a special visit to Violet F. Stout Park in Powder Springs, where participants will have the opportunity to meet the horses, learn about the therapeutic program, and gain

insight into the training, care, and daily responsibilities of the mounted patrol unit. This engaging and educational experience offers a unique behind-the-scenes look at how these remarkable horses serve and support our community.

FREEMAN FOODIES

Friday, April 17 | 11:30 a.m.–1 p.m.
Lunch on your own; *Registration required.*
Chili’s, 4145 Austell Road, Austell

STRENGTH TRAINING FOR OSTEOPOROSIS

Monday April 20 | Noon–1 p.m.
Free; *Registration required.*
This educational seminar introduces safe and effective strength-training principles specifically designed for individuals living with osteoporosis. Participants will learn how targeted, low-impact exercises can help maintain and even improve bone density, enhance posture and balance, and reduce the risk of falls and fractures. The session will also cover proper body mechanics, movements to avoid, and practical tips for building confidence while staying active. Presented by health professionals from WellStar Health System.

MEET VINNY THE ARSON DOG

Tuesday April 21 | 12:30–1:30 p.m.
Free; *Registration required.*
Did you know the Cobb County Fire Department has an arson detection dog named Vinny? Come meet Vinny and his handler, learn about his specialized training, and discover how he helps investigators uncover the cause of fires in our community.

AARP SMART DRIVER

Wednesday, April 22 | 9:30 a.m.–3:30 p.m.
Please arrive by 9 a.m.; \$20 AARP members; \$25.00 Non-members;
Registration required.

PLANNING WITH CONFIDENCE: FINANCIAL & LEGAL ORGANIZATION

Wednesday April 22 | Noon–1 p.m.
Free; *Registration required.*
Even in the digital world, there are legal and financial documents and information that are crucial to keep and be able to locate. We will discuss a variety of tools to keep this information safe, organized and available when you need it.

THE BREMAN MUSEUM

Friday, May 22. (See May 22 listing)
Payment due at registration. **Registration deadline: April 22.** Price includes admission & transportation. No refunds will be given unless the trip is canceled. Activity Level 3—Longer walking, many stairs, and/or inclines. Mobility Requirements – travelers must be able to navigate on and off the bus independently. If you have any concerns with walking or climbing stairs, please check with staff before registering.

GET TO KNOW COBB: MEET COBB SHERIFF CRAIG OWENS

Wednesday April 28 | 1–2 p.m.
Free; *Registration required.*
Join us for an opportunity to meet Craig Owens, learn more about the Sheriff’s Office and its role in our community, and take part in an engaging Q&A session.

INTERGENERATIONAL MEMORY JARS

Thursday, April 30 | Noon–1 p.m.
\$5; *Registration required.*
Intergenerational Memory Jars is a meaningful program designed to bring people together through reflection and storytelling. Open to participants ages 8 and older, seniors are encouraged to bring their children, grandchildren, and great-grandchildren to share in this special experience. Participants will write down and exchange cherished memories, favorite traditions, and words of encouragement, preserving them in beautifully decorated keepsake jars. Through guided conversation and creative expression, the program fosters connection, mutual respect, and a strong sense of belonging across generations. Led by the dedicated staff of Freeman Poole Senior Center.

MAY

GUARDRAILS FOR PREVENTIVE MEASURES: CANCER AWARENESS.

Monday, May 4 | 11 a.m.–Noon
Free; *Registration required.*
Knowledge is one of the most powerful tools in cancer prevention. Cancer Awareness: Guardrails for Preventative Measures is an engaging, informative class designed to help participants understand risk factors, early warning signs, and practical steps that can reduce cancer risk. This session breaks down evidence-based prevention strategies, like screenings, lifestyle choices, and environmental awareness, into clear, actionable guidance you can use right away. Led by Keith Mazonkey, Wellness Coordinator with Cobb County Human Resources.

SALSA SENSATIONS: SALSA TASTING

Tuesday, May 5 | 1–2 p.m.
\$5; *Registration required.*
In honor of National Salsa Month, join us for a fun and flavorful afternoon! Sample a variety of mild to medium salsas while socializing and learning about the unique flavors and ingredients

that make each one special. This relaxed, interactive program is designed to spark conversation and delight your taste buds. Chips and refreshments will be provided. Led by the staff of Freeman Poole Senior Center.

WELCOME TO C. FREEMAN POOLE SENIOR CENTER

Wednesday, May 6 | 11 a.m.–Noon
Free; *Registration required.*
Whether you are new or have been a long-time member of C. Freeman Poole, you are invited to come and learn more about our center, the programs we offer, meet our team, take a tour of our center, and offer suggestions about activities, events, or seminars you would like to see offered.

MOTHER’S DAY TEA PARTY

Thursday, May 7 from 11 a.m. – 1 p.m.
\$10; *Registration required.*
Join us for a delightful Mother’s Day Tea Party at our senior center, where we celebrate the love, strength, and cherished memories of the wonderful mothers and mother figures in our community. Enjoy a relaxing afternoon filled with warm conversation, soothing tea, and a selection of light refreshments including finger sandwiches, scones, and sweet treats.



MINDFUL MILE WALK

Friday, May 8 | 10–11 a.m.
Free; *Registration required.*
In recognition of Mental Health Awareness Month, this gentle one-mile walk brings together participants ages eight and up to promote mindfulness, stress relief, and emotional well-being. Guided moments of reflection encourage connection, movement, and community support in a calm, welcoming environment. We will meet at the Silver Comet bike shop. Led by Freeman Poole Staff.

THE BREMAN MUSEUM

Friday, May 22 | 9 a.m.–3 p.m.
\$12; *Registration required.*
The Breman Museum is a cultural center that celebrates the joy and resiliency of life, connecting people from every walk of life. From engrossing conversations about the Holocaust and Civil Rights to captivating art collections and live musical performances, we welcome you to get inspired by remarkable moments and memories. **Payment due at registration. Registration deadline: April 22.** Price includes admission & transportation. No refunds will be given unless the trip is canceled. **Activity Level 3:** Longer walking, many stairs, and/or inclines. **Mobility Requirements** – travelers must be able to navigate on and off the bus independently. If you have any concerns with walking or climbing stairs, please check with staff before registering.



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NOTES & NOTICES

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EDUCATION OPPORTUNITIES

MONTHLY RECYCLING CENTER TOURS. The City of Smyrna Recycling Center offers monthly tours on the third Friday of the month (except for holidays) at 9 a.m. You can register to attend by visiting keepsmyrnabeautiful.com/education.

VOLUNTEER OPPORTUNITIES

INDIVIDUAL VOLUNTEER RECRUITMENT. Keep Smyrna Beautiful

relies on the power of volunteers to keep Smyrna clean, green, and beautiful. Details and a link to the volunteer application can be found at keepsmyrnabeautiful.com/volunteer.

PLACING NOTES & NOTICES ADS

Holding a garage sale? Selling or renting your home, need an employee, tutoring, teaching, or in-home child care? We accept short reader ads for a fee of \$25 per 50 words. The ads, with check, should be mailed or delivered to The Bright Side, 3330 Cumberland Blvd, Suite 500, Vinings, GA 30339. Ad copy should also be e-mailed to news@brightsidecobb.com. Check or credit card payments accepted. Home-based business ads accepted only if they do not conflict with our display advertisers. Home sale ads are for homeowners only. For more information, call 770-426-9388 or e-mail news@brightsidecobb.com.

MOBILE OUTREACH VAN BRINGS RESOURCES DIRECTLY TO COMMUNITIES

Wellstar Health System and Reflections of Trinity unveiled a co-branded mobile outreach van recently, expanding access to essential resources for communities across Metro Atlanta.

The vehicle is designed to bring food assistance, health education, benefits navigation, and wellness resources directly into neighborhoods with the greatest need as a sign of hope in motion.

Supported by Wellstar Center for Health Equity's Community Health Initiative, the mobile unit will help connect individuals and families to services such as SNAP and Medicaid while also addressing broader social

drivers of health, including food insecurity, transportation barriers and access to care.

The outreach effort will serve communities across Cobb, Douglas, Paulding and Fulton counties, increasing Reflections of Trinity's ability to meet residents where they are and extend its reach beyond a single location.

The initiative expands community-based partnerships beyond clinical care, bringing leaders and partners together to strengthen community health while focusing on high-need areas to improve access to essential resources across the region.

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A group of six people, including three in high-visibility vests, standing in front of a brick wall and a sign that says "WENDOS".

On Sunday, May 3 from 3–4 p.m., Todd DeFeo, a member of the Friends of the Smyrna Library board and publisher/editor of Railfanning.org, will present the lecture “Transcontinental Railroad” highlighting how the national railroad network led to the adoption of a standard gauge, including the Western & Atlantic that passes through Smyrna.

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I'll stop any attempt to undermine our elections. I'm fighting so every eligible Georgian can vote securely, fairly and without any outside interference.

Expanding Educational Opportunity

I'll expand Georgia Pre-K for every child and protect the HOPE Scholarship so every hardworking student can afford college.

Enhancing Public Safety

Public safety requires fairness and accountability. I'll ensure our legal system is effective, trusted and secures every neighborhood.



SCAN TO LEARN MORE

ELECTION DAY: MAY 19, 2026
EARLY VOTING STARTS APRIL 27

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**SENIORS INVITED
TO ANNUAL EXPO**

Join other Seniors for a day filled with resources, connections, and valuable information at the Cobb County Senior Services Annual Expo. Mark your calendar for Wednesday, April 21, from 10 a.m. to 2 p.m. at Jim Miller Park, 2245 Callaway Road, Marietta. This free event is open to the public, and parking is FREE.

Discover a variety of vendors offering services in life enrichment, transportation, nutrition, senior living, Medicare, wellness, safety, and much more. There will be free health screenings, and informative seminars on important topics throughout the day.

Be sure to check cobbseniors.org for updates on vendors, health screenings, and seminar details as we get closer to the event. Don't miss this opportunity to explore helpful resources, learn something new, and connect with your community.

This special Seniors expo is presented by Wellstar Health System.



ANNUAL EXPO

April 21, 2026
10 AM - 2 PM
JIM R. MILLER PARK & EVENT CENTER
2245 CALLAWAY ROAD, MARIETTA, GA 30008

A free event for adults 55+, caregivers, and the community to explore resources including:

- Meals
- Senior Living
- Screenings
- Transportation
- Medicare
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- Life Enrichment
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